

STATION 33 · FIRST SENTENCE ALOUD

October

TWENTY TWENTY - SIX

ISSUE TWO · EDUCATOR EDITION

A field atlas for the teacher who never planned to teach language.

Station Log

Readings taken during the second month of the school year.

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■ structure

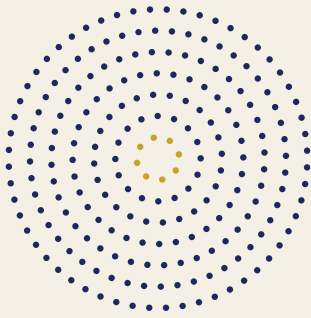
■ signal — the reading that matters

Published by EL Publishing · Richard A. Daniel, M.Ed. · ENL / EL Specialist, Laurel High School

Written for general-education teachers with English learners on the roster.

From the Desk

Issue Two. The honeymoon month is over; the real year begins.



OCTOBER
READING 02

September is introductions. October is when the room settles into whatever it is going to be, and for an English learner that settling can go two ways. Either the class becomes a place with predictable routines, visible language, and a teacher who waits — or it becomes a place to disappear quietly into the back row for nine months.

This issue is about the first kind of room. Seventeen plates, each one a single idea you can carry into fourth period tomorrow: how to read silence, how to grade content without grading English, what a word problem is really asking, what to say to a family across a conference table when you do not share a language.

None of it requires a second language. All of it requires the belief that the student in front of you is already thinking in full sentences — just not yet in yours.

Every teacher is a language teacher. This is the field manual.

— *R. A. Daniel, M.Ed.*

ENL / EL Specialist · Laurel High School · Laurel, Mississippi

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PLATES IN THIS ISSUE

4

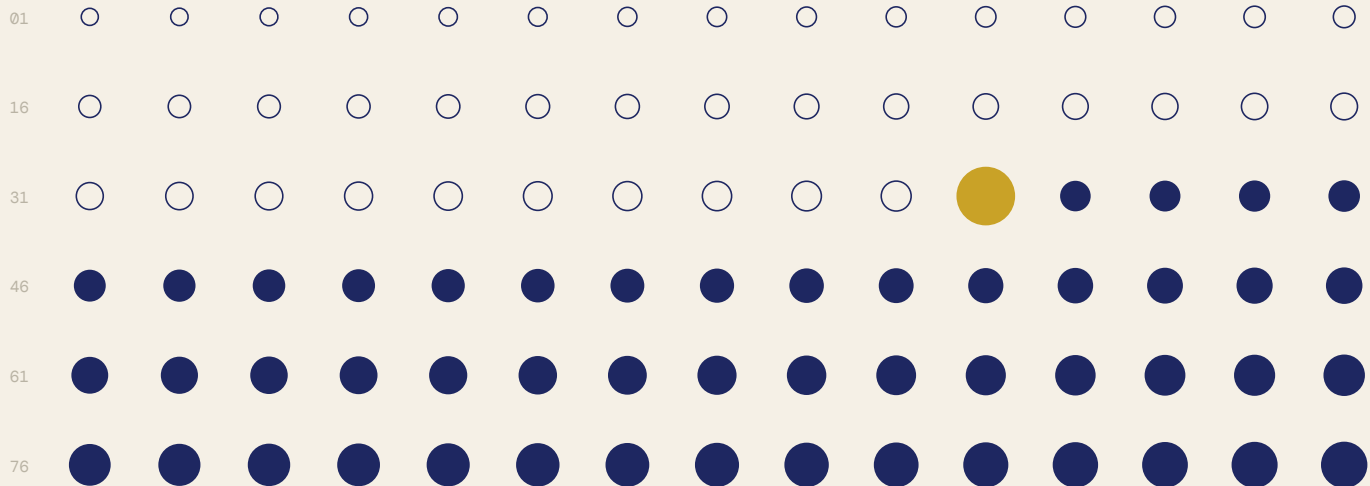
LANES IN EVERY ROOM

5

MINUTES ON MONDAY

The Silent Period

Listening is not nothing. It is the first reading.



DAY 01

DAY 90 — hollow: silent · filled: producing · gold: first sentence

WHAT IT IS

- A normal stage, not a deficit. Newcomers may produce almost no English for weeks or months while comprehension grows daily.
- Length varies with age, prior schooling, personality, and how safe the room feels. Older students are often quieter longer — the stakes of being wrong feel higher.
- The student is working. Mapping your routines, your gestures, the sound of instructions, who to copy.

WHAT TO DO

- Accept non-verbal answers: point, sort, match, draw, thumbs, choose between two cards.
- Narrate what you do in short, repeated phrases. Same words for the same actions, every day.
- Seat them beside a patient peer, ideally one who shares a language. Ask nothing publicly until they volunteer.
- When the first sentence comes, answer the meaning — not the grammar.

TRY TUESDAY

Give every direction three ways this week — say it, show it, write it on the board. Count how many times a silent student does the right thing without a word.

Four Lanes

One room. Four altitudes. The same destination.

PROFICIENT · EXIT

NEWCOMER <i>arriving</i>	EMERGING <i>ELPA2I1-2</i>	PROGRESSING <i>ELPA2I3-4</i>	CHALLENGE <i>toward proficient</i>
L1	L1-2	L3-4	L4-5

ONE TASK, FOUR WAYS · "Explain why the colonists were angry about the Stamp Act."

NEWCOMER

Match 4 pictures to 4 words:
tax, king, paper, angry. Circle
the angry face. Say one word.

EMERGING

Frame: "The colonists were angry because the king ____."
Word bank of five verbs. Two sentences.

PROGRESSING

Frame: "Although ____, the colonists felt ____ because ____." One paragraph with two reasons and one quote.

CHALLENGE

No frame. Compare the Stamp Act to one modern tax dispute in a paragraph; cite the text twice.

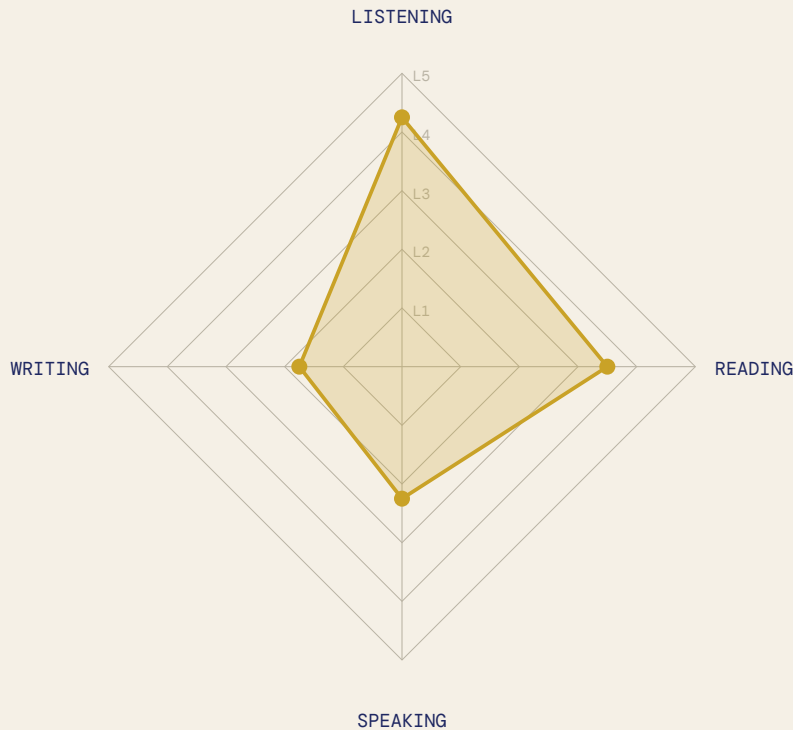
THE RULES OF THE MODEL

- Same text, same standard, same objective on the board. What changes is the scaffold and the size of the output — never the thinking.
- Lanes are not seats. A student can be Progressing in reading and Emerging in writing on the same day. Assign by task, not by label.
- Scaffolds thin as the lane rises: pictures → word bank → frame → no frame. The horizon never moves.

Storm Studio : four-lane differentiation model : ELPA21 proficiency bands

The Four Domains

What ELPA21 actually measures — and what each one looks like in your room.



A TYPICAL YEAR-TWO PROFILE: RECEPTIVE DOMAINS RUN AHEAD OF PRODUCTIVE ONES

RECEPTIVE — what they take in

- **Listening:** following multi-step directions, catching the main idea of a mini-lecture, hearing the difference between “can” and “can’t.” Support: slow down, chunk, repeat key phrase verbatim.
- **Reading:** vocabulary in context, text structure, inference. Support: preview the text’s headings and pictures, pre-teach five words, read the first paragraph aloud.

PRODUCTIVE — what they put out

- **Speaking:** usually the lowest and most public score. Support: partner before whole-class, frames, wait time, accept accented and imperfect answers as correct answers.
- **Writing:** sentence control, organization, academic word choice. Support: model the paragraph, give the frame, grade the idea first and the grammar second.

READ THE PROFILE

Ask your EL specialist for each student’s four domain scores, not just the overall level. A 4-4-2-2 student needs a different Tuesday than a 3-3-3-3 student.

Monday Moves

Five moves. Five minutes. Every Monday of the year.

W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10	W11	W12
W13	W14	W15	W16	W17	W18	W19	W20	W21	W22	W23	W24
W25	W26	W27	W28	W29	W30	W31	W32	W33	W34	W35	W36

AUG

OCTOBER · WEEKS 7-10

MAY

- 01

Say it, show it, write it

Every direction in three channels. The board is the third channel — leave it up.
- 02

Wait seven seconds

Ask, then count silently. Silence is translation happening, not refusal. Most teachers wait under two.
- 03

Frame the sentence

“I notice ___ because ___.” One frame on the board turns a shrug into an answer.
- 04

Partner before public

Every question gets rehearsed with one peer first. Cold-calling an EL without rehearsal teaches silence.
- 05

Word wall, used daily

Ten words for the unit, posted with a picture. Point to it. Say it. Make them say it. Grade it Friday.

THIS MONTH'S MOVE

Week 7 is Move 02. Pick one class period, ask one real question, and wait the full seven seconds. Write down who answered who never had before.

The Language of Math

The problem is rarely the math. It is the eleven words wrapped around it.

A has 3 times as many chickens as cows. If there are 48 animals altogether,
how many cows are there?

■ signal words – the language that carries the operation

— content nouns – the language that carries the story

SIGNAL WORDS ELs MOST OFTEN MISREAD · and the operation each one hides

times as many as	■	multiply · then compare
altogether / in all	■	add
how many more than	■	subtract
each / per	■	divide or multiply
left / remain	■	subtract
of (□ of 40)	■	multiply
if ... then	■	condition, not sequence

WHY IT BREAKS

- “Times as many as” reads like three separate words. Spanish speakers hear “veces” but nothing marks the comparison.
- “If” signals a hypothetical in English. Many students read it as “first.”
- Small words carry the weight: of, per, than, each. They are the least visible and the most tested.

WHAT WORKS

- Read the problem aloud once before anyone touches a pencil. Then have students circle the numbers and box the question.
- Post a signal-word wall in the math room, with the operation beside each. Add to it every week.
- Let them explain the plan in Spanish to a partner, then write the equation. The math was never the problem.

Three Tiers of Words

Where to spend your vocabulary minutes. Hint: the middle.



WIDTH = SHARE OF A GEN-ED TEACHER'S VOCABULARY TIME THAT SHOULD GO TO EACH TIER

THE ARGUMENT

- Tier 1 arrives on its own from friends, TV, and the hallway. Tier 3 you already teach — it is in the unit, bolded, on the test.
- Tier 2 is the gap. “Evaluate,” “however,” “despite,” “approximately” appear in every class and get taught explicitly in none. ELs stall here for years.
- A student who knows “photosynthesis” but not “process” cannot answer “Describe the process of photosynthesis.”

TEN FOR OCTOBER

- analyze · evidence · contrast · although · sequence · significant · approximately · however · determine · support
- Post them. Use each one aloud three times a day. Require one in every written answer this month. Grade for the attempt, not the spelling.

TRY TUESDAY

Pull your next test. Highlight every Tier 2 word in the directions and question stems. That list is your vocabulary lesson for the week before the test.

Beck, McKeown & Kucan, three-tier model · MS ELP Standard 8, Meaning of words and phrases

The Frames Bank

Sentence starters by function and lane. Cut, post, use.

	EMERGING	PROGRESSING	CHALLENGE
DESCRIBE	This is a _____. It has _____.	One _____ of _____ is _____. Another is _____.	The most notable feature of _____ is _____, which suggests _____.
COMPARE	_____ and _____ are both _____.	_____ is _____, but _____ is _____.	While _____ and _____ share _____, they differ in _____.
CAUSE / EFFECT	_____ happened because _____.	Because _____, _____. As a result, _____.	One consequence of _____ was _____, which in turn led to _____.
SEQUENCE	First _____. Then _____. Last _____.	Before _____, _____. After that, _____.	Initially _____; subsequently _____; ultimately _____.
ARGUE	I think _____ because _____.	In my opinion _____. The evidence is _____.	Although some argue _____, the evidence shows _____ because _____.

HOW TO USE A FRAME

- A frame is scaffolding, not a worksheet. Say it aloud, model one answer, then have partners try it before anyone writes.
- Newcomers get the Emerging frame plus a word bank. Take frames away one column at a time as the month goes on — the goal is to not need them.

Grading What They Know

Separate the language from the content. Then grade the content.

WHAT THE STUDENT KNOWS · grade this

HOW WELL IT WAS SAID IN ENGLISH · coach this

A SCIENCE ANSWER WITH FOUR GRAMMAR ERRORS AND THE RIGHT MECHANISM IS A CORRECT SCIENCE ANSWER

ACCOMMODATIONS YOU CAN GIVE TODAY · MTAM-aligned

- Extended time — the single most effective and most under-used accommodation.
- Bilingual word-to-word dictionary (no definitions). Allowed on MAAP; allow it on yours.
- Directions read aloud and clarified in plain English. Test items read aloud on math and science, not on ELA reading passages.
- Small-group or separate setting. Fewer items per page. Answers written directly in the test booklet.

GRADING PRACTICES THAT HOLD UP

- Write two rubrics lines: content and language. Weight content. Report both so growth in language is visible too.
- Accept answers in drawings, labeled diagrams, or Spanish with a partner's English gloss for newcomers in the first semester.
- Never a zero for silence. An un-attempted item for an EL is missing data, not a failing score. Re-ask it another way.
- The LSP is the contract. If it says extended time, a grade given without it is not defensible.

THE ONE QUESTION

Before you enter a grade for an English learner, ask: if this student had written it perfectly in Spanish, what grade would the idea earn? Start there.

The Compliance Desk

October, plotted. Thirty-one days, five Mondays, one date that matters.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
			01	02	03	04
05 Monday Move	06	07	08	09	10	11
12 Monday Move	13	14	15 HHM closes	16	17	18
19 Monday Move	20	21	22	23	24	25
26 Monday Move	27	28	29	30	31	

ON THE DESK THIS MONTH

- Every EL has a current LSP on file and every teacher of record has read it and signed that they did.
- Accommodations are living in the gradebook and the test settings, not just the cum folder.
- First-quarter grades checked against the §15 EL progress pool — a failing EL in October is a May problem you can still fix.
- Parent notification sent in a language the family can read. Logged. Dated. Copied to the folder.

THE FRAMEWORK, IN ONE BREATH

- Title III funds the services. EEOA (1974) requires “appropriate action” to overcome language barriers.
- Castañeda (1981) tests that action three ways: sound theory, adequate resources, actual results.
- ELPA21 is the annual measure; MS §15 puts EL progress into the school’s accountability grade. Your gradebook is evidence.

Family Voices

Conference season, in two languages. What to say across the table.

SCHOOL □ HOME



HOME □ SCHOOL · the direction most conferences forget

ENGLISH

ESPAÑOL

Thank you for coming. Your child is working hard.

Gracias por venir. Su hijo/a está trabajando mucho.

Here is what is going well.

Esto es lo que va bien.

Here is one thing we are working on.

Esto es algo en lo que estamos trabajando.

What does your child say about school at home?

¿Qué dice su hijo/a de la escuela en casa?

What do you want me to know?

¿Qué quiere que yo sepa?

How can I reach you? Text, call, or WhatsApp?

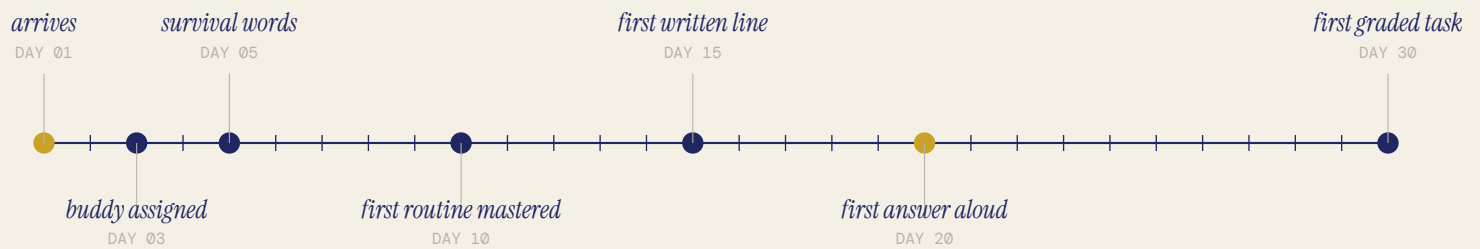
¿Cómo puedo comunicarme con usted? ¿Mensaje, llamada o WhatsApp?

GROUND RULES

- Never use the student as the interpreter for their own conference. Ask the office for an interpreter or a phone line; the district is required to provide one.
- Lead with a strength, in detail. Families of ELs often hear only problems. Bring one piece of work to hand them.
- Ask, then wait. The second question — “What do you want me to know?” — is where the useful information lives.

The First Thirty Days

A newcomer's month, day by day. What the room owes them, and when.



WEEK ONE · safety

- A seat near the front and beside a bilingual buddy. A printed schedule with room numbers and teacher photos.
- Twenty survival words and phrases on a card: bathroom, water, help, I don't understand, please repeat, where is.
- No grades. Presence, participation by pointing, and one smile a period.

WEEKS TWO-THREE · routine

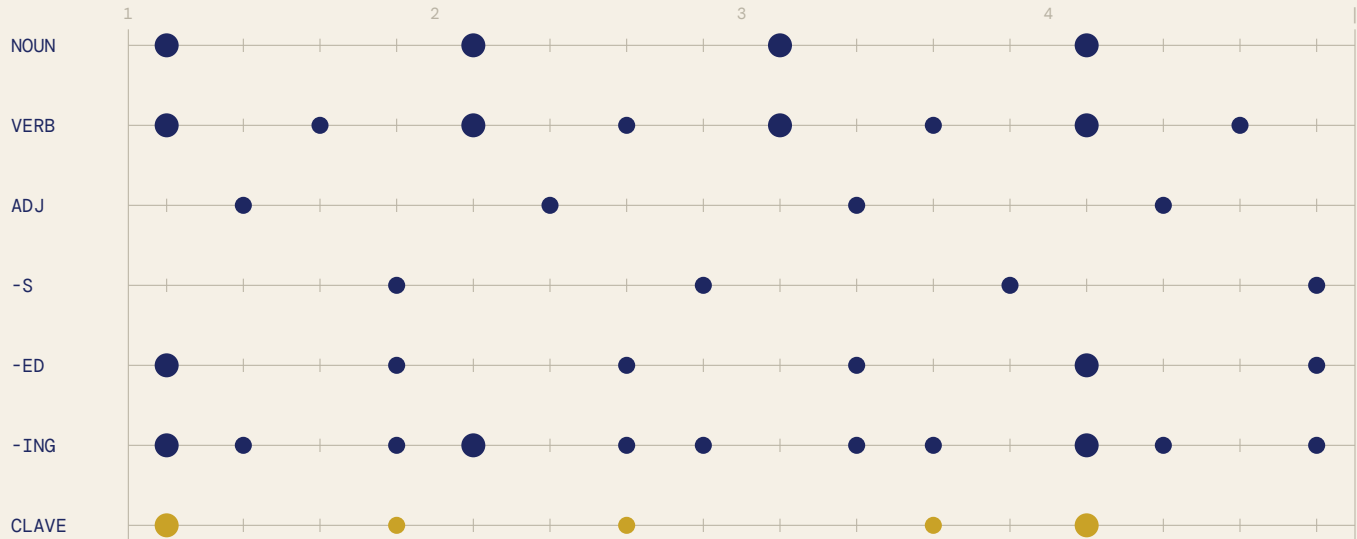
- Every class has one predictable routine the student can do without instructions: bell work, exit ticket, a labeled diagram.
- First written lines: copying, then a frame. First spoken answer: rehearsed with the buddy, volunteered, never demanded.

WEEK FOUR · evidence

- The first graded task uses the Newcomer lane: pictures, word bank, one sentence. It goes in the folder as a baseline you will compare against in December.
- By day 30 the EL specialist should have the screener score, the LSP drafted, and every teacher's signature. If any of those is missing, ask.

Grammar Beats

Ritmos de gramática. A rule you can clap is a rule you keep.



OCTOBER SESSION · GRADE 10 · ENGLISH II · PAST vs. PROGRESSIVE

Walk-ed, talk-ed, jump-ed — past.

Walk-ing, talk-ing, jump-ing — now.

Clap the clave. Say the rule. Keep the time.

WHY RHYTHM

- Inflections (-s, -ed, -ing) are unstressed in English and nearly inaudible to a Spanish-dominant ear. Putting them on the beat makes them loud.
- A three-minute clap-and-chant at the start of class is rehearsal for the whole period's writing.

RUN THE SESSION

- 1. Teacher claps the clave; class echoes. 2. Add the words on the beat. 3. Students write three sentences using the pattern. 4. Swap papers; circle every inflection.
- Recorded albums exist for the MAAP-tested grades (3–8, English II) in The Blueprint / El Plano.

Readable: The Fair

One text, two lanes, three questions. Photocopy this page.

EMERGING · ELPA21 1-2 · ~80 words

Every October, the Mississippi State Fair comes to Jackson. It is big. There are rides, lights, and music. You can smell fried food and sweet funnel cakes. Farmers bring cows, goats, and pigs to show. Students from many schools come on buses. Some students speak English. Some speak Spanish. At the fair, everyone is loud and happy. The fair lasts about twelve days. Then the lights go out until next year.

PROGRESSING · ELPA21 3-4 · ~150 words

Each October the Mississippi State Fair transforms the fairgrounds in Jackson into a small city of lights. For roughly twelve days, visitors arrive from every county to ride the Ferris wheel, watch livestock competitions, and eat food that exists nowhere else in the calendar. Although the rides draw the crowds, the fair began as an agricultural event, and it still is one: young farmers spend months raising a calf or a goat to show in the ring, and a blue ribbon can mean a scholarship. Schools across the state bring students by the busload. In the crowd you hear English, Spanish, and Vietnamese, sometimes in the same conversation. When the last night ends, the lights are packed into trucks, and the fairgrounds return to quiet until the following fall.

THREE QUESTIONS · same questions, both lanes

1 When does the fair happen, and where?

Emerging: circle the month and the city in the text. Progressing: answer in one full sentence.

2 Why did the fair begin? Find the sentence that tells you.

Emerging frame: “The fair began as ____.” Progressing: explain what “still is one” refers to.

3 The text says the crowd speaks many languages. Why might the writer include that?

Emerging: choose — a) it is loud b) many kinds of people come c) the food is good. Progressing: two sentences with a reason.

Tier 2 words to pre-teach: transform · roughly · although · competition · exists · return

Ask the Specialist

Four questions from the hallway, answered before the bell.

“He speaks English fine at lunch. Why is he still an EL?”

Playground English arrives in one to two years. Academic English — the language of textbooks, tests, and essays — takes five to seven. Social fluency is real and it is not the same skill. ELPA21 measures the second one, and the exit criteria are set by the state, not by how he sounds in the cafeteria.

“Can I just let her use Google Translate?”

For a newcomer reading directions, yes, and it beats sitting lost. For producing her own writing, use it as a bridge, not a destination: she drafts in Spanish, translates, then rewrites the translation in her own words with a frame. Grade the rewrite. The tool should be visibly doing less by December.

“She never turns anything in. Is that a language problem or a behavior problem?”

Before you decide, check three things: can she read the assignment page, does she know when it is due, and has anyone shown her one finished example. Silence and non-completion are what an unclear task looks like from the outside. Then, if all three are in place, treat it as you would for any student.

“I have 28 kids and two ELs. How much am I supposed to do?”

Nothing separate. The moves in this issue — wait time, frames, three-channel directions, word walls — are good teaching for all 28. The ELs are the students for whom it stops being optional. Start with one move and keep it for a month.

Send a question: rdaniel@laurelschools.org · answers appear in the next plate set

The Shelf

Tools you can open today. All free, all built for Mississippi rooms.

Many Voices — Student Magazine, Issue 1

For grades 9–12 ELs. Three reading levels per article, tappable glossary with Spanish, quizzes, a passport.

radan55.github.io/elstudentmagazine01/

The Blueprint / El Plano

Bilingual EN/ES site on the Mississippi ELA blueprints, K–12: skill ladders, test-style items, Grammar Beats, family pages.

radan55.github.io/mselablueprintinfo01/

Reading Check: How Tamales Are Made

One article, a quiz, a sequencing lab, and a Google Form teacher setup. A model for any content text.

radan55.github.io/tamales02/

Hispanic Heritage Month Gallery

Bilingual biographies for the bulletin board and the projector — through October 15.

radan55.github.io/hispanicheritagemonth2026/

The EL Field Guide

“Every Teacher Is a Language Teacher.” The pocket version of this magazine.

EL Resource Catalog

SIOP Model at a Glance

Eight components, one page. Post it by the lesson-plan binder.

EL Resource Catalog

ELPA21 Practice Suite

Domain-by-domain practice in the test’s own format.

EL Resource Catalog

Monday Moves

The 36-week staff card series this issue’s Plate IV comes from.

Staff mailbox, every Monday

gold: live on GitHub Pages now · navy: in the EL Resource Catalog or by request

The Tech Shelf

Five new tools, verified this month. All free, all on a Chromebook but one.

01

Read Along in Google Classroom

READING · SPEAKING · LISTENING

Google · free in every Education edition since June 2026

Students read aloud and get real-time pronunciation help; you upload your own text or have Gemini write a story at grade level from the unit's words. Spanish supported.

In the block: Fluency station for the Newcomer/Emerging lane while you conference with Progressing.

02

Microsoft Reading Coach

SPEAKING · READING

Microsoft · coach.microsoft.com · free, browser

Assign a passage by link, track words-per-minute and accuracy; AI flags mispronounced words for syllable-level practice. Stories in 14 languages.

In the block: Weekly pronunciation clinic: same 150-word passage, reread to 95%. Harvest the error list for Monday.

03

NotebookLM for Education

LISTENING · READING · SPEAKING

Google · opened to under-18 Education accounts Aug 2025 · admin enables

Upload the week's article and it produces a two-host podcast discussion of that exact text, with Audio Overviews in 50+ languages.

In the block: Progressing lane listens and fills a note organizer, then records a 60-second summary. Emerging hears the Spanish overview first.

04

Diffit, 2025 edition

READING · WRITING

Diffit · free tier prints and PDFs · teacher-facing, no student login

Paste any text or URL; get leveled versions, vocabulary, and questions. Mid-2025 added click-to-edit rewriting and translated directions.

In the block: One article at four lanes, Spanish directions for newcomers, same three questions, mixed-level groups compare.

05

Google Translate “Practice”

LISTENING · SPEAKING

Google · Aug 2025 beta · phone app only (iOS/Android), 13+

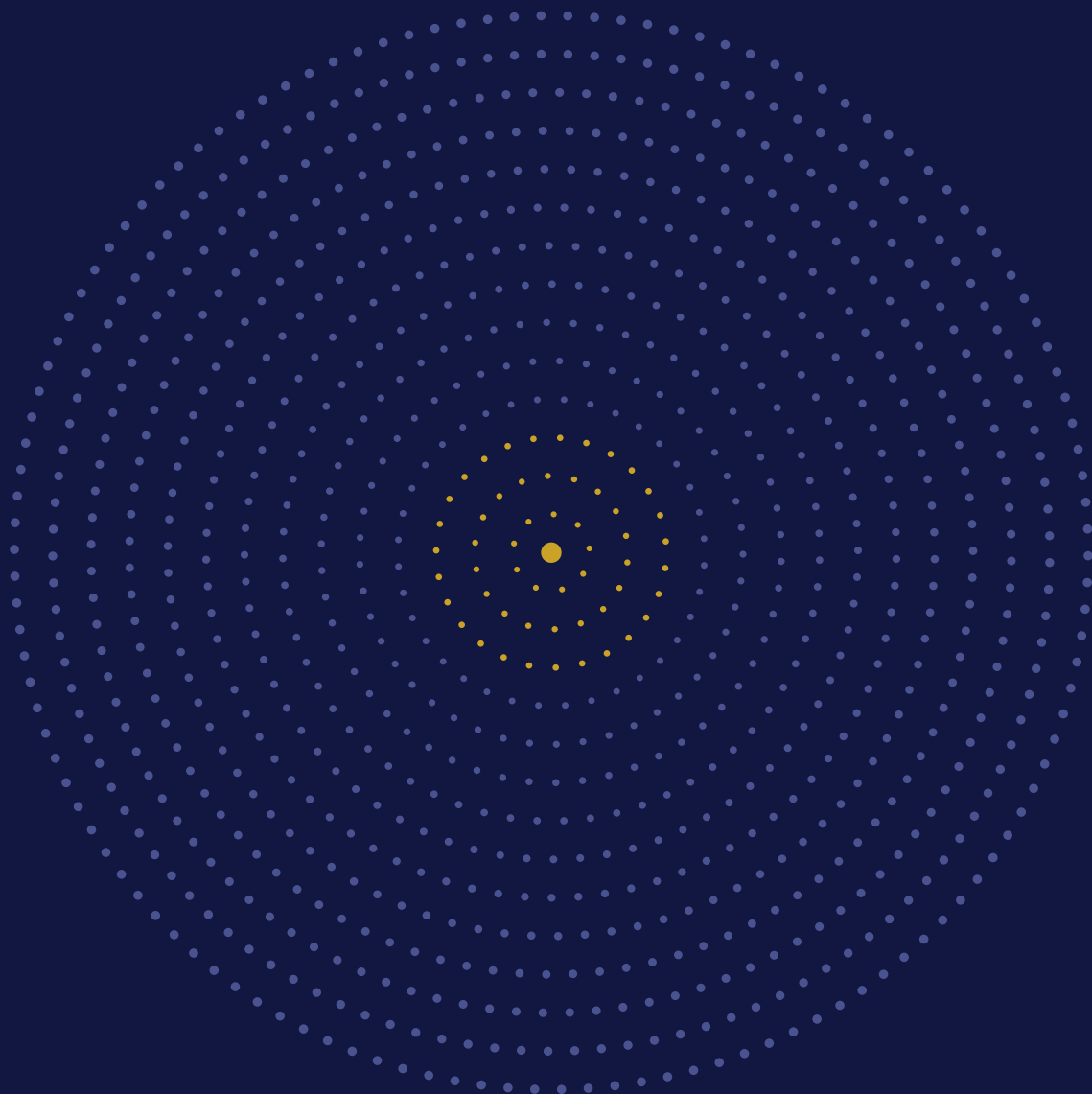
Builds personalized listening and speaking scenarios for Spanish speakers learning English, with daily progress.

In the block: Last ten minutes: one “at school” scenario, then exit-ticket three new phrases.

WATCH LIST

Google Learn Your Way (re-levels textbook chapters; own-PDF upload still waitlisted) · Little Language Lessons, Google Labs · Gemini in Classroom (teacher-only, 18+ — a prep tool, not a student one).

Verified against 2025-2026 release notes · nothing Mississippi-specific surfaced this month



MANY VOICES

ONE STORM

Every teacher is a language teacher.

Nobody should have to figure it out alone.

EL PUBLISHING · radan55.github.io · NEXT PLATE SET: NOVEMBER 2026